

JEWELRY TRADER

ESTATE & FINE JEWELRY

Application Overview

One system for the shop counter, the stockroom and the website
— with cataloguing that keeps pace with the stock coming through
the door.

Catalogued in minutes

Photograph a piece on a tablet
and the record comes back
mostly written.

Every piece, tracked

From the moment it arrives to
the moment it sells — or
comes back.

Sold once, never twice

One-of-a-kind stock cannot be
sold twice, in the shop or
online.

Nothing unexplained

Every price change, discount
and refund carries a name and
a reason.

What the system does

A piece is photographed and catalogued once. From then on, the same record serves the appraiser, the salesperson at the counter, the customer browsing online, and the bookkeeper at month end.

Jewelry Trader is built for dealers in antique, vintage, estate, designer and fine jewelry — where almost every item is unique, values are high, and provenance matters. It runs across several shops and several salespeople without the stock records drifting apart.

Where the work happens

AREA	ADDRESS	WHO USES IT, AND FOR WHAT
Admin	/admin	Managers, appraisers and bookkeepers. Stock, intake, approvals, orders, customers, reports and settings.
The register	/pos	Sales staff at the counter. A full-screen till: search, cart, payment, returns and receipts.
The shop window	/	Customers. Browse the collection, view a piece, buy it, and see their order history.
The collection	/collection	The public catalogue, with filters for category, period, metal and price.

Admin and the register both run in a browser on a desktop, a tablet or a phone — cataloguing in particular is built for a tablet held over the piece. Addresses shown are on the current installation; they become your own web address once the system is published.

What makes it different from a general-purpose till

Built for speed at intake

Cataloguing is the bottleneck in this trade. Photographs are read for metal, period, stones, hallmarks and condition, and come back as suggestions a person confirms — so a piece can be live in minutes rather than the better part of an hour.

Built for unique stock

Most retail software assumes ten of everything. Here each piece is singular, so the system guarantees it cannot be sold twice — the shop and the website share one stock record, checked at the moment of payment.

Built for provenance

Condition, restoration history, hallmarks, gemstone detail and appraisal values travel with the piece, and price history is kept rather than overwritten.

Built for accountability

High-value trade attracts scrutiny. Every change is recorded against a person with a time and a reason, and the riskiest actions need a second person's approval.

Built to be adjusted by you

Tax rates, discount limits, commission structures, what each category must record, return windows and receipt wording are all settings — changed by your own team, without a developer.

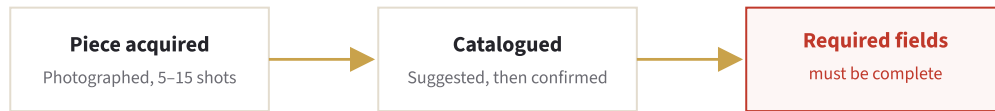
Built to outlast its suppliers

Nothing is welded to one outside company. The card processor and the service that reads photographs are both chosen on a settings screen, and either can be replaced without rebuilding the shop around it.

How a piece moves through the business

The path every item follows, from the moment it is acquired to the moment it leaves — and what happens if it comes back.

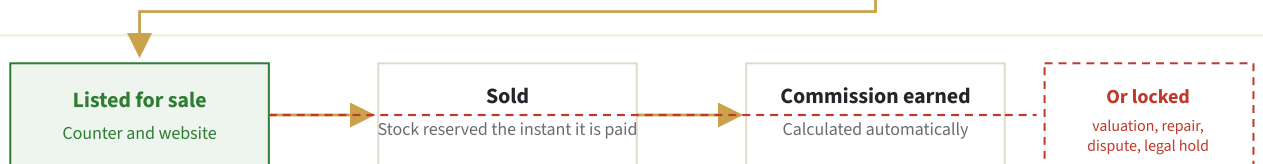
INTAKE



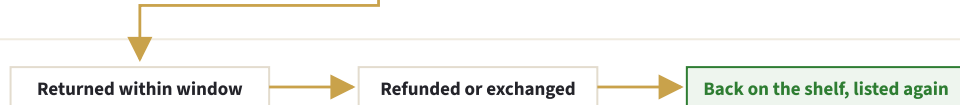
REVIEW



SELLING



AFTER



The life of a piece. Dashed paths are the exceptions: sent back for more detail, or held off sale.

Two sets of eyes

Whoever catalogues a piece cannot publish it alone. A reviewer checks the record, then approves it — and listing it for sale is a second, separate decision.

Sold means sold

The moment payment succeeds, the piece is claimed. Two customers cannot buy the same ring, even if one is at the counter and the other is online at the same second.

Returns close the loop

A returned piece goes back on the shelf and reappears for sale automatically, with the money returned to however the customer paid.

The item record

What the system holds about a piece — and how staff can see, at a glance, what is finished and what still needs work.

The traffic-light system

Every field on an item carries a colour. Staff do not have to remember what a bracelet needs versus what a ring needs — the record shows them.

COLOUR	MEANING	WHAT IT DOES
● Red	Required, still empty	The piece cannot be submitted until it is filled in.
● Yellow	Worth verifying	Filled in, but flagged as needing a second look.
● Green	Complete	Turns green by itself the moment a valid value is entered.
● Gray	Not applicable	Greyed out for this kind of item — chain length on a ring, for instance.
● Blue	Changed by a person	Marks where someone overrode a value, so the change is visible.

What each category requires is yours to decide. A ring can demand a size, a necklace a chain length, a watch a movement type — set from the settings screen, by your own staff, taking effect immediately.

What is captured

Identity and materials Reference number, title, category, maker or brand, style period, metal type and purity, weight, measurements, hallmark.	Condition and history Condition and restoration notes, internal remarks kept away from customers, and a provenance trail showing who did what, and when.
Gemstones Stone type, shape, cut, colour, estimated carat weight and setting style — several stones per piece, with the principal stone marked.	Photography Each shot tagged by what it shows — front, back, side, hallmark, gemstone, clasp, movement, signature, packaging, certificate — and one chosen as the image customers see first.
Valuation Acquisition cost, retail price, insurance value, negotiation floor and promotional price. Changing a price keeps the old one on record rather than erasing it.	Descriptions Separate wording for the customer, for search engines, for marketplaces and for social media — so each audience reads copy written for it.

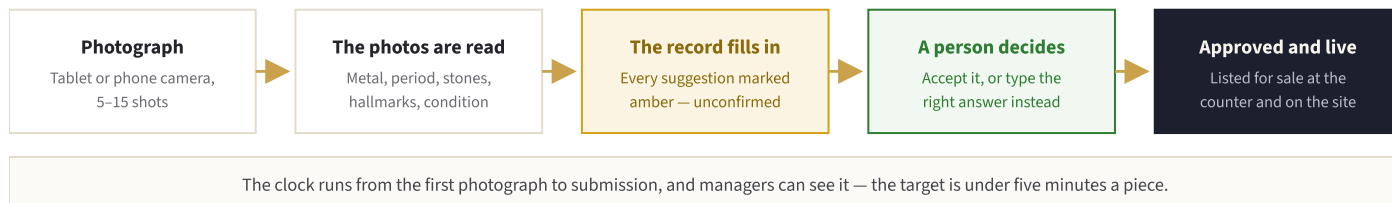
Moving stock between shops

A transfer is requested, approved by the manager of the shop sending it, then confirmed on arrival. The piece is marked in transit in between, so it cannot be sold by either shop while it is in a courier's hands.

Cataloguing in minutes

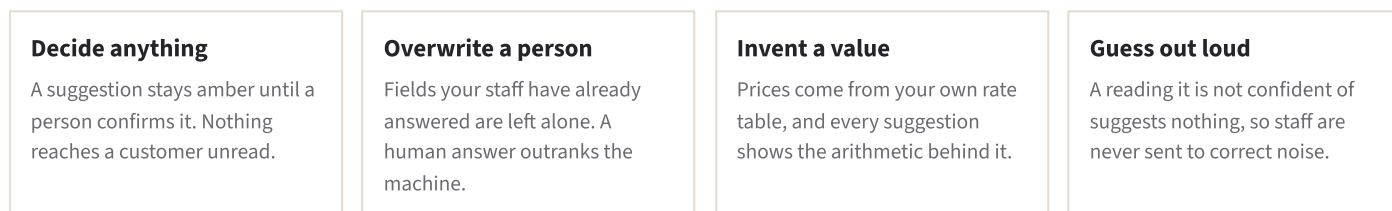
Photograph a piece on a tablet or a phone and the record comes back mostly written. Staff confirm what is right, correct what is not, and the piece is live in minutes rather than the better part of an hour.

ON THE DEVICE IN YOUR HAND



The intake path, from the first photograph to a piece listed for sale.

Four things it will not do



A suggestion is never a decision

This is what the colour system was built for. A field holding a suggestion is amber *whatever it contains* — a confident answer still reads as unfinished until a person accepts it. Accepting turns it green; typing something else turns it blue and records what was suggested, what the person put instead, and who they were.

That record is an asset, not paperwork. Every correction your appraisers make is kept, so you build a written history of where the readings are weak on your own kind of stock — and a competitor using the same service off the shelf will not have it.

And a price, with its arithmetic

A piece is priced by arithmetic you control, not by opinion: the craftsman's four-step method, from what the piece cost to what it sells for, with every percentage yours to set. The next section sets it out in full. Anything the system could not establish is listed as missing rather than quietly assumed.

Descriptions, written for each audience

From the confirmed record — not from the photographs — the system drafts wording for the customer, for search engines, for marketplaces and for social media, plus the internal note. Written from the record, the copy can only claim what the record claims: no invented carat weights, no invented dates. House style is a setting, so the voice stays yours.

No supplier lock-in, and off until you switch it on. The reading service is chosen on a settings screen — address, key and model are form entries, and no supplier's name appears anywhere in the software. With none configured, cataloguing works by hand exactly as today: nothing in the shop depends on it being reachable.

How a price is built

Every price starts from the craftsman's four-step method — the arithmetic bench jewellers have used for generations to get a piece from raw materials to a ticket. Everything else is a refinement on top of it.

THE FOUR STEPS, IN THIS ORDER, EACH BUILDING ON THE LAST

Step 1 • Determining factors

What the piece actually cost you: bench work and setting, plus the metal and the stones.

\$1,380.00

▼

Step 2 • Basic price

10% overhead and 5% design · 100% – 15% = 85% · \$1,380.00 ÷ 0.85

\$1,623.53

▼

Step 3 • Wholesale price

10% wholesale commission · 100% – 10% = 90% · \$1,623.53 ÷ 0.90

\$1,803.92

▼

Step 4 • Retail price

50% retail commission · 100% – 50% = 50% · \$1,803.92 ÷ 0.50 = \$3,607.85
— rounded up, because \$3,607.85 is not a price anybody writes on a ticket

\$3,608.00

An Art Deco platinum ring: \$180 of bench work on \$1,200 of metal and stones.

Why it divides rather than adds

A markup is never added on. It is taken out of 100% and the running price divided by what remains. The difference is not academic: add 50% to \$1,803.92 and the agent's half is \$901.96, which is not half of what the customer pays. Divide by 0.50 and it is \$1,803.92, which is. Each step works the same way and builds on the one before, so the order is part of the method.

The formula does not change. The percentages do. Overhead, design, and both commissions are settings — and they can differ by category, because a watch does not carry a ring's economics. Change one and the screen recalculates a worked example in front of you, before you save.

What sits on top of it

Four layers refine what the formula produces, each switching on and off on its own:

LAYER	WHAT IT DOES	DEFAULT
Base rates	Value per gram by metal and purity, per carat by stone. Maintained by your own appraisers.	Always on — it is what everything else falls back to
Live metal rates	Prices the metal at the market instead of at your table, adjusted for the purity actually in the piece.	Off until you want it
Maker, period, condition	A signed piece, an Art Deco piece, or one in exceptional condition is worth more than its materials and labour.	On
Market adjustments	Category demand, the season, and how long the piece has been sitting.	Off until you want it

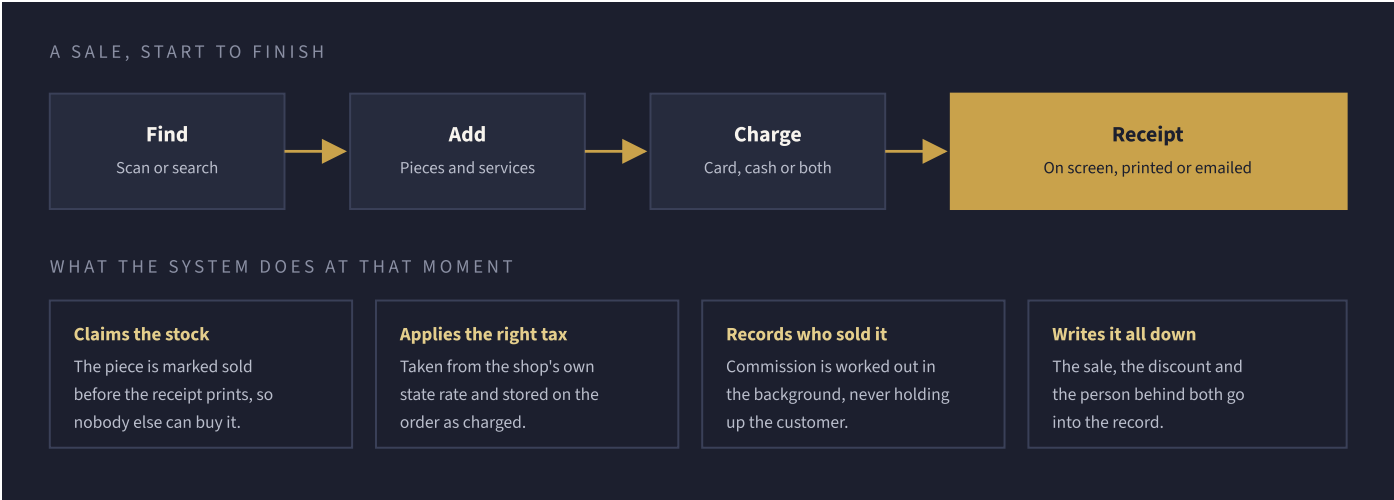
A feed being down is not your problem. If the live market feed is slow, unreachable or silent on a metal, the system prices from your own table instead and says so in the working. Pricing a piece never waits on somebody else's uptime.

The working is kept, not just shown

When a customer asks why a piece is \$3,608, the answer is on the screen: every step, every percentage, every rate. The working is filed alongside the price it produced, so a price set this year can still be defended in three years' time, after the rates behind it have moved.

At the counter

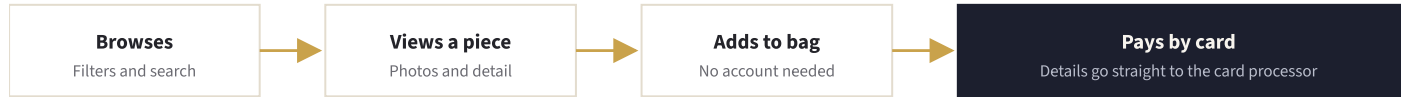
A full-screen till designed so an ordinary sale takes well under two minutes, with the awkward cases handled properly rather than worked around.



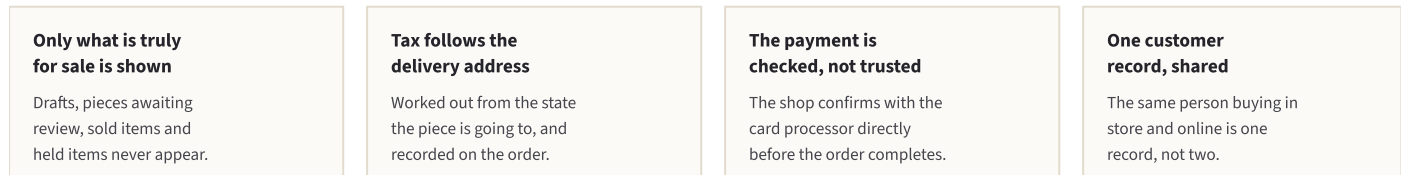
The website

The same stock, the same prices, the same records — presented to customers, and kept in step with the shop floor automatically.

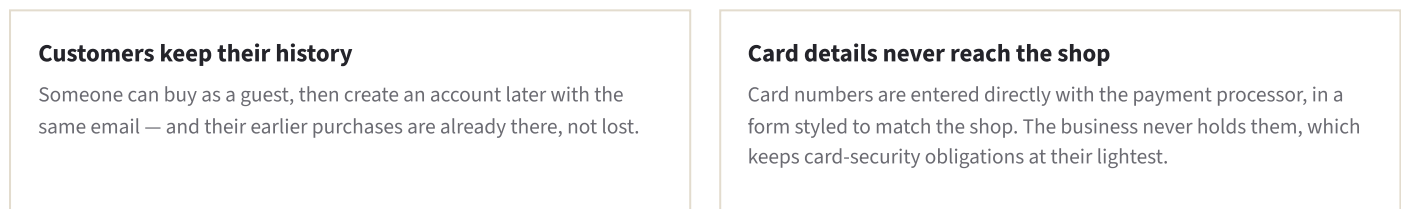
WHAT THE CUSTOMER DOES



WHAT HAPPENS BEHIND IT



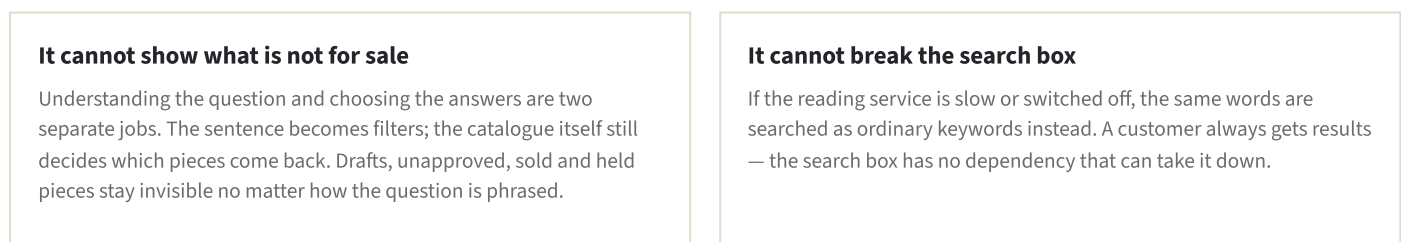
The customer's path, and the four safeguards working underneath it.



Sold in the shop, gone from the website. If a piece sells at the counter while someone has it in their online basket, it disappears from that basket rather than allowing a sale that cannot be honoured.

Customers can search the way they speak

A customer who types *“art deco sapphire ring under five thousand”* gets exactly that. The sentence is read into the filters the catalogue already uses — period, stone, category and a price ceiling — and the shop shows what it understood, so the customer can see how their words were taken and adjust them.



Commission and pay

Four ways to structure commission, worked out automatically on every sale, and reported in a form payroll can use.

The four structures

STRUCTURE	HOW IT IS WORKED OUT	EXAMPLE ON A \$1,000 SALE
On sales	A flat percentage of the sale	At 5% — \$50.00
On profit	A percentage of what the piece made over what it cost	Bought at \$450, at 20% of margin — \$110.00
Tiered	The rate rises once a salesperson passes a threshold	4% under \$5,000, 6% above
Shared	A pool split between everyone involved in the sale	At 5%, split 60/40 — \$30.00 and \$20.00

The rules it follows

- **Sales tax is never commissionable** — it was never the shop's money.
- **Discounts reduce commission proportionally**, so discounting costs the salesperson as well as the shop.
- **A shared pool always adds up exactly**. Where a split does not divide evenly, the odd cents are distributed rather than lost — the parts always total the pool to the penny.
- **It never delays a customer**. The calculation happens after the sale completes, in the background.
- **Anyone without their own agreement** falls back to the standard arrangement you have configured.

Built around California wage law

Written agreements	Each salesperson's actual agreed terms are stored alongside the numbers, because the rate alone is not the agreement.
No clawbacks	Nothing automatically takes money back from commission already earned. A refund leaves the commission standing; any reduction must be raised, reasoned and approved by a manager.
Payment timing	Approving a commission and paying it are recorded as separate, dated steps, so wage timing can be evidenced.

Reporting

Daily, weekly or monthly, filtered by salesperson, shop and status. Salespeople see their own figures; managers and bookkeepers see everyone's. The export for payroll can be shaped to whatever columns your payroll provider expects, without waiting on a developer.

Control and accountability

Who can do what, what needs a second person, and the record that sits behind all of it.

Six kinds of staff account

ROLE	WHAT THEY CAN DO
Owner / Super Admin	Everything, including settings, staff accounts and approvals.
Shop Manager	Stock, orders, approvals, discounts above the staff limit, and reports for their shop.
Sales Staff	The counter, creating and editing stock subject to approval, and their own commission.
Appraiser	Cataloguing and approving pieces for sale. No selling.
Bookkeeper	Financial and commission reports, payment records, payroll export. No stock edits, no selling.
Customer Service	Orders, customers and returns. No discounting, no price changes.

These are starting points, not fixed. You can create your own roles and choose exactly what each can do.

Protections around the risky actions

Two-factor sign-in

You choose which roles must use an authenticator app. Those staff are enrolled on first sign-in and challenged every time after. Nobody is exempt — not even the owner's account.

A second challenge for the riskiest actions

Approving an override or changing payment settings asks for a private symbol challenge only trusted staff know the answers to. Every attempt, successful or not, is recorded.

Overrides need a reason and approval

Selling below the floor price, discounting past the limit, releasing a held piece or accepting a late return all require a written reason and a second person's approval — including when the owner does it themselves.

Holds on individual pieces

A piece can be held from sale, from editing, from the website, or frozen entirely — for a valuation, a repair, a consignment dispute or a legal hold — with the reason shown to any member of staff who tries.

The record behind everything

Every change to a piece, an order, a payment, a customer or a setting is recorded automatically: who did it, when, from where, and what the value was before and after. Sign-ins, failed sign-ins and refused approvals are recorded too.

Financial records are kept for seven years to meet tax recordkeeping expectations, while general day-to-day activity is kept for a shorter, configurable period.

Feature list

Everything delivered and working today, at a glance.

Stock and cataloguing

✓ Guided intake

Photographs, then fields, then submit — with progress shown as you go.

✓ Colour-coded fields

Required, verify, complete, not applicable and changed-by-hand.

✓ Rules per category

Decide what a ring must have versus a brooch, yourself.

✓ Photography by type

Ten shot types, with a chosen hero image.

✓ Gemstone detail

Several stones per piece, with the principal stone marked.

✓ Price history

Every price the piece has carried, kept rather than overwritten.

✓ Review and approval

Approve for the record; list for sale as a separate decision.

✓ Multi-shop stock

Every piece belongs to a shop, with transfers and approvals.

✓ Intake speed tracking

How long cataloguing takes, shown to managers.

✓ Search and filtering

By reference, title, maker, shop, status and category.

Assisted cataloguing and pricing

✓ Catalogue on a tablet

Photograph straight from the device camera, at the bench or in a client's home.

✓ Photographs read for you

Metal, period, stones, hallmarks and condition come back as suggestions.

✓ Confirm or correct, field by field

Nothing is accepted on your behalf; one tap accepts, typing replaces.

✓ The craftsman's formula

Four steps from cost to ticket, with every step shown.

✓ Percentages per category

A watch does not carry a ring's economics.

✓ Your own rate table

Metal, stone, maker, period and condition rates, maintained by your staff.

✓ Live metal rates, optional

Market pricing when you want it; your own table when you don't.

✓ Every step switchable

Test a pricing strategy without the rest of the stack moving.

✓ Workings kept with the price

Explain a price years later, after the rates behind it have moved.

✓ Four sets of copy drafted

Customer, search engine, marketplace and social, from the confirmed record.

✓ Corrections remembered

Every change from a suggestion is kept, with who made it and when.

✓ Any supplier, or none

Chosen on a settings screen; cataloguing still works fully by hand.

✓ Under five minutes, measured

Time from first photograph to submission, reported to managers.

Selling

✓ Full-screen till

Large targets, minimal clicks, built for a counter.

✓ Card, cash or split

Any combination, with change calculated.

✓ Services on a sale

Sizing, repairs and workshop work as line items.

✓ Discounts with limits

Percentage or amount, capped until a manager approves.

✓ Returns and refunds

Tax included, back to the original payment method.

✓ Exchanges

One transaction; only the difference changes hands.

✓ Receipts

On screen, on a till roll, and by email.

✓ Automatic tax

Per shop, by state, recorded as charged.

Online

✓ Public catalogue Filter by category, period, metal and price; sort by price or newest.	✓ Keyword search Across titles, makers, periods, metals and descriptions.	✓ Search in plain language “Art deco sapphire under five thousand”, with what was understood shown back.
✓ Piece pages Gallery, full specification and gemstone detail.	✓ Guest checkout No account required to buy.	✓ Customer accounts Order history and saved address, claimable after a guest purchase.
✓ Live stock accuracy Sold pieces vanish from baskets and listings at once.		

Money, people and oversight

✓ Four commission structures Sales, profit, tiered and shared.	✓ Per-person agreements With the written terms stored alongside.	✓ Commission reporting Daily, weekly, monthly, by person and shop.
✓ Payroll export Shaped to your payroll provider's format.	✓ Six staff roles Plus custom roles you define yourself.	✓ Two-factor sign-in Required for whichever roles you choose.
✓ Full activity record Searchable, with before-and-after values.	✓ Overrides and holds Reasoned, approved and recorded.	

Prepared for what comes next

Three further capabilities are already accounted for in the design, so adding one later is building on the foundation rather than disturbing it.

CAPABILITY	WHAT IT WILL DO	ALREADY IN PLACE
Rentals	Short-term hire of showcase pieces, with deposits, deductible options, and inspection on return.	Agreements and claims are accounted for, and a piece can already be held back from rental specifically while staying on sale.
Salesperson shopfronts	A personal storefront for each salesperson, with their own branding and their commission on what they refer.	Shared commission already splits a single sale between several people, and stock requests are accounted for.
Quarterly stock audit	Scheduled physical counts per shop, with variance reports and exceptions to investigate.	Every stock movement is already recorded — which is exactly the data a reconciliation reads.

Why that matters commercially

Each of these was designed for from the start rather than bolted on afterwards. The parts of the system they will touch — how stock is held back, how a sale is shared between people, how movements are recorded — already work the way those features will need them to.

In practice that means a shorter, lower-risk piece of work when you decide to add one, and no disruption to what is already running in the shop.

Two decisions to make before the reading service goes on

Assisted cataloguing is built and working, and needs two business choices rather than any further development:

- **Which service reads the photographs**, and on which commercial terms. It is entered on a settings screen, so the choice can be made — and changed — without touching the software.
- **Your opening rates**: value per gram by metal and purity, value per carat by stone, and the multipliers for maker, period and condition. A first pass takes an afternoon with an appraiser, and they are yours to adjust as the market moves.

Until both are in place, cataloguing works fully by hand, exactly as the rest of the system does.